

American bullfrog

Rana catesbeiana

- ↔ 4–8 in (10–20 cm)
- 📍 SE. Canada, W., C., and E. US; introduced to Europe, South America, and E. Asia
- ⊗ Common



Males of North America's biggest species of frog are so vocal in defending their territories that their call has been likened to a roaring bull, inspiring the common name. Groups of males even call together in chorus. The American bullfrog is native to the eastern US, but has spread to other parts of the world—including Europe—where its predatory habits make it a destructive invasive species.

Wood frog

Lithobates sylvatica

- ↔ 2–3 in (5–8 cm)
- 📍 Canada, E. US
- ⊗ Common

This frog's blood contains anti-freeze chemicals, enabling it to reach further north into the Arctic than any other American frog. It is one of the first frogs to emerge from hibernation in spring, when it favors temporary seasonal rain pools for breeding. These have the benefit of lacking predatory fish—but the strategy carries the risk of entire broods being lost if pools dry up too soon.

Marsh frog

Pelophylax ridibundus

- ↔ 4–6 in (10–15.2 cm)
- 📍 Europe, W. and SW. Asia
- ⊗ Common

This frog is the largest in Europe—and big enough to take prey up to the size of mice, lizards, and snakes. It is related to the European common frog, but the marsh frog is larger and spends more time in water. It thrives in many aquatic habitats—including lakes, ditches, and streams—and can even tolerate the salty water around the shores of the Caspian Sea. Females lay up to 12,000 eggs in the water.

Goliath frog

Conraua goliath

- ↔ 4–16 in (10–40 cm)
- 📍 Cameroon, Equatorial Guinea
- ⊗ Endangered

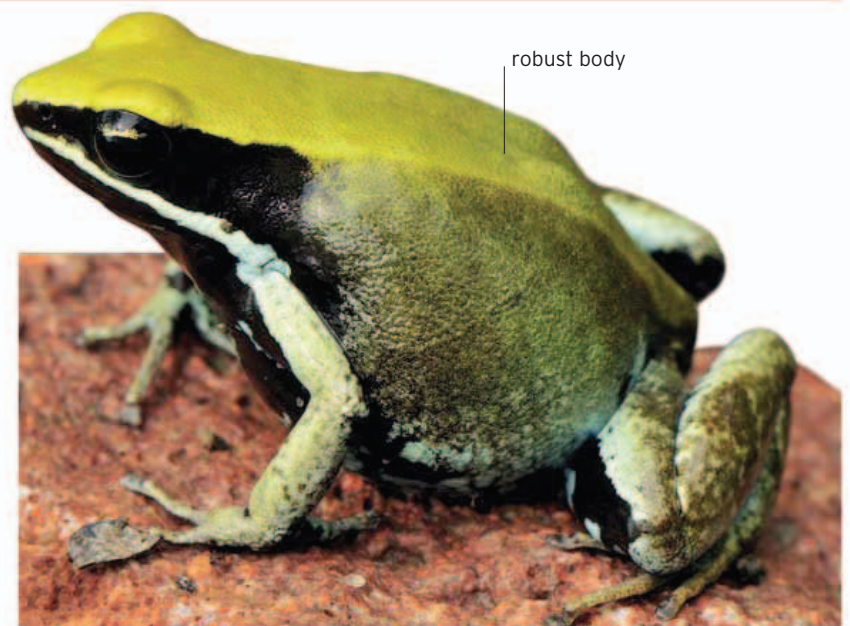
This rainforest amphibian grows bigger than any other species of frog or toad. In its native Cameroon, it inhabits clean, well-oxygenated, fast-flowing streams. Unusually for frogs, the goliath frog lacks a vocal sac—adults are silent, even when breeding. Males are larger than females and assemble stony nests to accommodate the female's eggs—perhaps as a way of stopping them from being washed downriver.

Green mantella

Mantella viridis

- ↔ 1 in (2.5 cm)
- 📍 N. and E. Madagascar
- ⊗ Endangered

Mantellas are small, strikingly colored frogs that are confined to the island of Madagascar. Like the poison frogs of South America, their bodies harness toxins from the tiny invertebrates they eat—then store them in their skin. The colors warn of toxicity. This green or yellow species has a prominent black face mask and—like others—is endangered by habitat loss and the exotic animal trade.

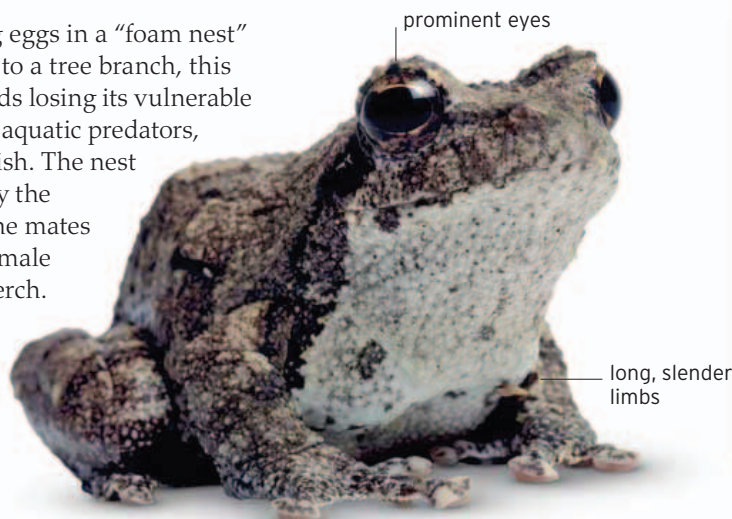


Gray foam-nest frog

Chiromantis xerampelina

- ↔ 2–4 in (5–10 cm)
- 📍 S. Africa
- ⊗ Common

By laying eggs in a “foam nest” attached to a tree branch, this frog avoids losing its vulnerable clutch to aquatic predators, such as fish. The nest is built by the male as he mates with a female on her perch.



More than 10 males may gather in a mating frenzy to fertilize the eggs. Hatched tadpoles drop into a pool beneath the nest. Usually gray or pale brown, this frog can change color for camouflage.

Tailed frog

Ascaphus truei

- ↔ 1–2 in (2.5–5 cm)
- 📍 SW. Canada, NW. US
- ⊗ Locally common

This green, brown, gray, or reddish amphibian is the only aquatic frog that breeds by internal fertilization. During mating, the male uses his unique “tail”—an extension of his cloaca—to deposit sperm inside the female's cloaca. Eggs are laid in cold mountain streams, and the hatching tadpoles take two years to mature. The tadpoles have large, suckerlike mouths so they can attach themselves to the underside of rocks and avoid being swept away by fast-flowing currents.

Other species

- Argentine horned frog *Ceratophrys ornata* » p121
- Couch's spadefoot *Scaphiopus couchii* » p64
- Dyeing poison frog *Dendrobates tinctorius* » p98
- Green tree frog *Litoria caerulea* » p326
- Midwife toad *Alytes obstetricans* » p162
- Red-eyed tree frog *Agalychnis callidryas* » pp82–83
- Tomato frog *Dyscophus antongillii* » p243
- Trueb's cochran frog *Nymphargus truebae* » p89
- Wallace's flying frog *Rhacophorus nigropalmatus* » p300
- Yellow-legged frog *Rana sierrae* » p59